

employ, but I also depend on friends and family members to share their unwanted inserts with me.

Unfortunately, or fortunately (depending upon how you look at it), after intensively researching coupon fraud, I have become a convert to the idea of banning all coupon sales. Why? Because I've gotten a glimpse into the dark underbelly of the coupon world, and it isn't pretty.



It was way too easy for me to unearth counterfeit coupons listed on eBay just by doing a search under "free coupon." I discovered dozens of listings of coupons for free products, sold by sellers whose selling history I scrutinized carefully. There is absolutely no legitimate method of obtaining as many free product coupons as these sellers were listing, not even if they'd written hundreds of complaint letters to companies and received free coupons in return. As for the clipping services, until I scrutinized the fine print on the majority of coupons, I'd never considered that a concern. After all, these were legitimate manufacturer coupons and buyers weren't being charged for the coupons, but the service of the clipping. Except, if that is true, why is a buyer charged more for a \$5 coupon than a 50¢ coupon? If the fine print on the coupon states that it isn't allowed to be sold, it's hard to rationalize that pricing. I've had to adjust my purchasing and stockpiling